Software Requirements Specification for Software Engineering: PronoucedFish (Ghoti)

Team 22, Ghoti
Hemal Rajput
Gurmanjot Minhas
James Araiche
Lily Porter
Sarah Dorfman

October 26, 2026

Contents

1 Reference Material **iv**
- 1.1 Table of Units . . . iv
- 1.2 Table of Symbols . . . iv
- 1.3 Abbreviations and Acronyms . . . v
- 1.4 Mathematical Notation . . . vi

2 Introduction **1**
- 2.1 Purpose of Document . . . 1
- 2.2 Scope of Requirements . . . 1
- 2.3 Characteristics of Intended Reader . . . 2
- 2.4 Organization of Document . . . 2

3 General System Description **3**
- 3.1 System Context . . . 3
  - 3.1.1 System Diagram . . . 3
  - 3.1.2 Patient Responsibilities . . . 3
  - 3.1.3 SLP Responsibilities . . . 4
  - 3.1.4 Context of Typical Use . . . 4
  - 3.1.5 Auxilliary System Diagrams . . . 5
- 3.2 User Characteristics . . . 8
  - 3.2.1 Patient . . . 8
  - 3.2.2 SLP . . . 8
- 3.3 System Constraints . . . 9

4 Specific System Description **9**
- 4.1 Problem Description . . . 9
  - 4.1.1 Physical System Description . . . 9
  - 4.1.2 Goal Statements . . . 10
  - 4.1.3 Scope Decisions . . . 10
  - 4.1.4 Assumptions . . . 11
  - 4.1.5 Theoretical Models . . . 12
  - 4.1.6 General Definitions . . . 12
  - 4.1.7 Data Definitions . . . 12

5 Requirements **12**
- 5.1 Functional Requirements . . . 13
  - 5.1.1 Audio Capture Requirements . . . 13
  - 5.1.2 Session Management Requirements . . . 13
  - 5.1.3 Speech Analysis Requirements . . . 13
  - 5.1.4 Results & Data Visualization Requirements . . . 14
  - 5.1.5 Progress & Data Management Requirements . . . 15

5.1.6 Practice Activities Requirements . . . 16
5.2 Nonfunctional Requirements . . . 17
5.2.1 Accuracy Requirements . . . 17
5.2.2 Performance Requirements . . . 17
5.2.3 Usability Requirements . . . 17
5.2.4 Maintainability Requirements . . . 18
5.2.5 Portability Requirements . . . 18
5.2.6 Reliability Requirements . . . 19
5.2.7 Security and Privacy: . . . 19
5.2.8 Legal and Licensing: . . . 20

6 Likely Changes **20**

7 Unlikely Changes **21**

8 Traceability Matrices and Graphs **21**

9 Development Plan **26**

Revision History

Table 1: Revision History

Date	**Developer(s)**	**Change**
October 19th, 2026	All	Initial Revision for Deliverable 2

1 Reference Material

This section records information for easy reference.

1.1 Table of Units

Throughout this document SI (Système International d'Unités) is employed as the unit system. In addition to the basic units, several derived units are used as described below. For each unit, the symbol is given followed by a description of the unit and the SI name.

symbol	**unit**	**SI**
s	time	second
min	time	minute

1.2 Table of Symbols

The table that follows summarizes the symbols used in this document along with their units. The choice of symbols was made to be consistent with the heat transfer literature and with existing documentation for solar water heating systems. The symbols are listed in alphabetical order.

symbol	**unit**	**description**
x	dimensionless	expected phoneme
y	dimensionless	estimated phoneme
p	dimensionless	n dimensional matrix of phonological features
A	dimensionless	features of expected phoneme
B	dimensionless	features of estimated phoneme
$d_m(A, B)$	dimensionless	Manhattan distance between A and B

1.3 Abbreviations and Acronyms

symbol	description
A	Assumption
DD	Data Definition
GD	General Definition
GS	Goal Statement
IM	Instance Model
LC	Likely Change
PS	Physical System Description
R	Requirement
SRS	Software Requirements Specification
TM	Theoretical Model
SLP	Speech Language Pathologist
SODA	Substitution/Omission/Distortion/Articulation
SD	Scope Decision
SSD	Speech Sound Disorder
PHI	Personal Health Information
PHIPA	Personal Health Information Protection Act
FR	Functional Requirement
NFR	Nonfunctional Requirement
AC	Audio Capture
SM	Session Management
SA	Speech Analysis
RDV	Results and Data Visualization
DMR	Progress and Data Management Requirements
PAR	Practice Activities Requirements
ACU	Accuracy
PER	Performance
USA	Usability
MAI	Maintainability
POR	Portability
REL	Reliability
SAP	Security and Privacy
LAL	Legal and Licensing

1.4 Mathematical Notation

Let x represent the expected phoneme that the child is trying to produce.
Let y represent the phoneme estimated by the machine learning classification based on what the child actually produced.

$$features(phoneme) = p; p \in (-1, 0, 1)^n \tag{1}$$

Note: p is a representation of n phonological features of the phoneme.

Extract the phonological features of the expected and estimated phoneme:

$$A = features(x) \tag{2}$$

$$B = features(y) \tag{3}$$

Compare using Manhattan Distance to represent the magnitude of the error **?**:

$$d_m(A, B) = \sum_{i=0}^{n} |A_i - B_i| \tag{4}$$

This final value will be what we use to estimate the error in the childs pronunciation.

2 Introduction

A child's phonemic inventory (the sounds they are able to make) typically stabilizes by ages 4-6 Kid Sense Child Development, but this is not the case for many. In Ontario, roughly 1 in 10 children need extra help developing their speech and language skills Government of Ontario. Receiving proper treatment has proven to improve their self esteem, ability to socialize, and readiness for school Government of Ontario. The job of an SLP is to provide this treatment: they assess a child's speech, fluency, and articulation, and provide corresponding strategies to overcome their concerns.

The product "Pronounced Fish" is an assistive tool intended for SLPs to streamline their workflow, and offer complementary insights to assist with their consultations. This Software Requirements Specification (SRS) highlights all functionalities and expectations that guide the application's design. The current section describes the purpose of this document, project scope decisions, characteristics of the intended reader for the SRS, and a roadmap describing the topics covered by each section of the document.

2.1 Purpose of Document

The SRS will provide the formal requirements specification that any iteration of the product must adhere to. It compiles functional and non-functional requirements elicited from SLPs, children, and other relevant user groups that will guide the core development of this application. It will also outline some elements that are likely and unlikely to change through renditions of the product due to varying scope decisions, stakeholder needs, and user goals. A full list of goals and stakeholders can be found in the Problem Statement and Goals Document.

2.2 Scope of Requirements

Pediatric speech is very complicated because children are still learning how to coordinate their breath, lips, and brain to make certain sounds. This means it is normal for them to make mistakes around this age. By age 5, these features have generally stabilized so if a child is still making errors around this time, it suggests a need for speech therapy. Therefore, the product narrows down the target user space to children aged 4-6.

Speech errors can be narrowed down to one of four categories as per the SODA framework. This product focuses on addressing substitution errors: mistakes where children replace consonant sounds with the wrong one. For instance, pronouncing the word "rabbit" as "wabbit" substitutes the "r" for a "w".

Another factor that complicates analysis of a child's speech is their accent. Accents are tuned to pronounce certain sounds in certain ways, causing significant deviations between youth from different geographical regions. Therefore, the user space has been further narrowed down to handle Monolingual North American speakers.

This means that the scope has been constrained to address substitution speech errors for monolingual, North American English speakers aged between 4-6.

2.3 Characteristics of Intended Reader

This document acts as the bridge between the actual application and the project developers. The reader is expected to have the equivalent software design understanding of a McMaster University Level 3 Software Engineering student. They must have a first year engineering level understanding of linear algebra and vector difference. This is important to understand the accuracy and comparisons of different speech sounds. A very basic understanding of linguistics terminology is also needed. They must know what a phoneme is, have an idea of some common speech sound errors (i.e. SODA), and understand the purpose of an SLP.

2.4 Organization of Document

The document is organized as per the following template [Smith and Lai (2005); Smith et al. (2007); Smith and Koothoor (2016)]:

- **Section 1:** Contains reference material starting with a table of units, symbols, abbreviations, and mathematical notation.
- **Section 2:** The current section introduces the problem, purpose of the SRS, scope of the document, and characteristics of the intended reader.
- **Section 3:** Provides a high level description of the system context including its inputs, outputs, and the interfaces between it and its environment. These system characteristics are tied to those of the intended user, and the system's constraints.
- **Section 4:** Highlights the overarching **problem statement and goals**. It then expands on any modelling decisions, scope decisions, and assumptions used to shape the solution space.
- **Section 5:** Outlines all functional and non-functional requirements the system must abide by, and the rationale for including them.
- **Section 6:** Describes any likely changes that are expected to be made in future iterations of the software. These changes will add or enhance preexisting requirements.
- **Section 7:** Describes any elements of the software that are unlikely to change.
- **Section 8:** Maps traceability matrices that connect related requirements, assumptions, and constraints.
- **Section 9:** Describes the order in which the requirements will be implemented during the development phase.
- **References:** Citations for any referenced materials within the document.
- **Appendix:** Contains a group reflection on the developmental process of this document.

3 General System Description

This section provides general information about the system. It identifies the interfaces between the system and its environment, describes the user characteristics and lists the system constraints.

3.1 System Context

3.1.1 System Diagram

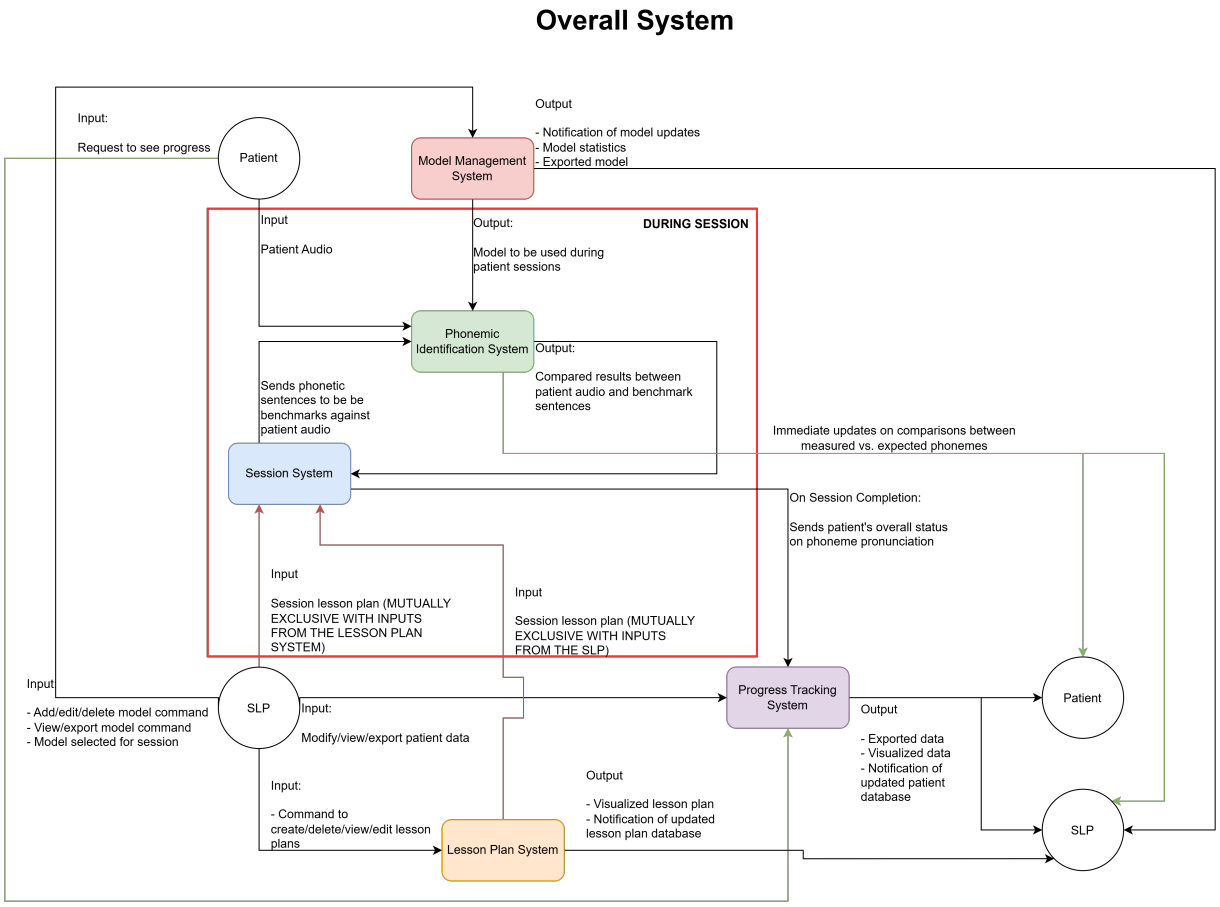


Figure 1: Overall System Diagram

3.1.2 Patient Responsibilities

P-R1: When a patient is providing audio to PronouncedFish to have their speech analyzed, it is their responsibility that the audio they output is as clear as possible and as accurate to the testing phrases as they can make it

P-R2: It is up to the patient or patient's parents/guardians that a patient is not sharing any sensitive medical data or personal information when they view their data

3.1.3 SLP Responsibilities

SLP-R1: It will be the SLP's responsibility to initiate sessions for patients. To begin a session, they will need to select the lesson plan they want to use for the session along with the phonemic identification model

SLP-R2: When an SLP makes a change to patient records, they are responsible for ensuring that the data they enter is accurate

SLP-R3: SLPs are responsible for any patient data that they delete from the system

SLP-R4: When a SLP adds or changes a lesson plan, they are responsible for ensuring the lesson plan contents are accurate to what they want to work on in a session with a patient

SLP-R5: SLPs are responsible for any lesson plans they delete in the system

SLP-R6: It is up to the SLP that whenever they export patient data for external usage, they follow PHIPA guidelines for keeping the data safe

SLP-R7: When an SLP wants to add or make an update a model, it is their responsibility to know where the model is sending data to ensure the system remains PHIPA compliant

SLP-R8: SLPs are responsible for any models they delete from the system

3.1.4 Context of Typical Use

The software will typically be used in medical applications for treating patients that have speech sound disorders (SSDs). The system is neither safety-critical nor mission-critical, should the system fail, users will not be in danger and critical business/societal infrastructure will not be impacted. Since PronouncedFish is primarily an assistant to SLPs, it is not autonomously making critical medical decisions. Should the system fail during treatment, the SLP can step in with their own judgements to correct issues that come from the system. Any administrative suggestions made by PronouncedFish can be overruled by an SLPs own judgement, helping to mitigate risk for end users.

3.1.5 Auxilliary System Diagrams

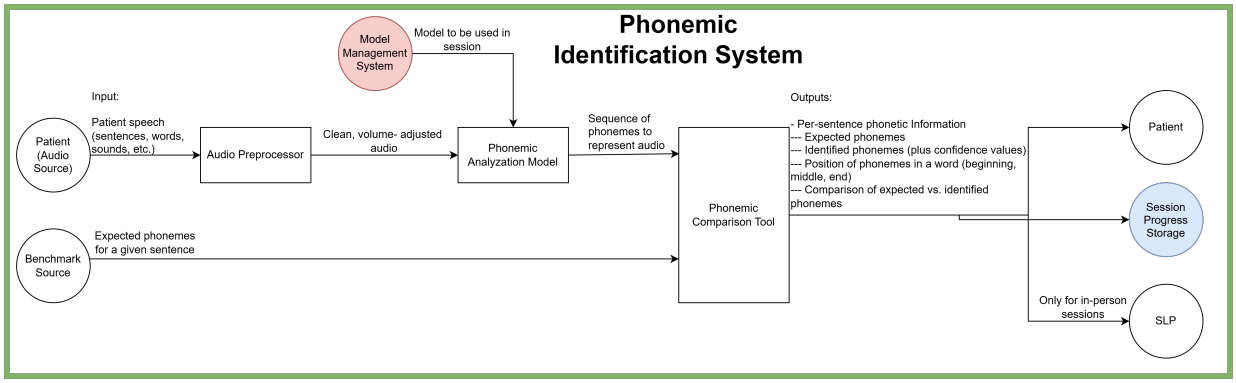


Figure 2: Phonemic Identification System

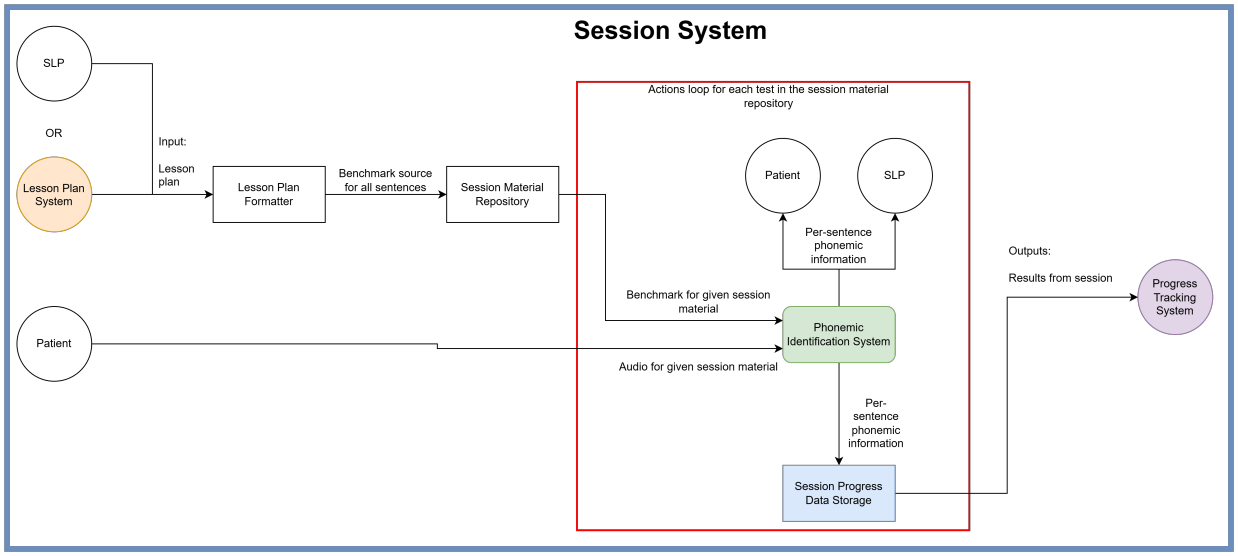


Figure 3: Session System

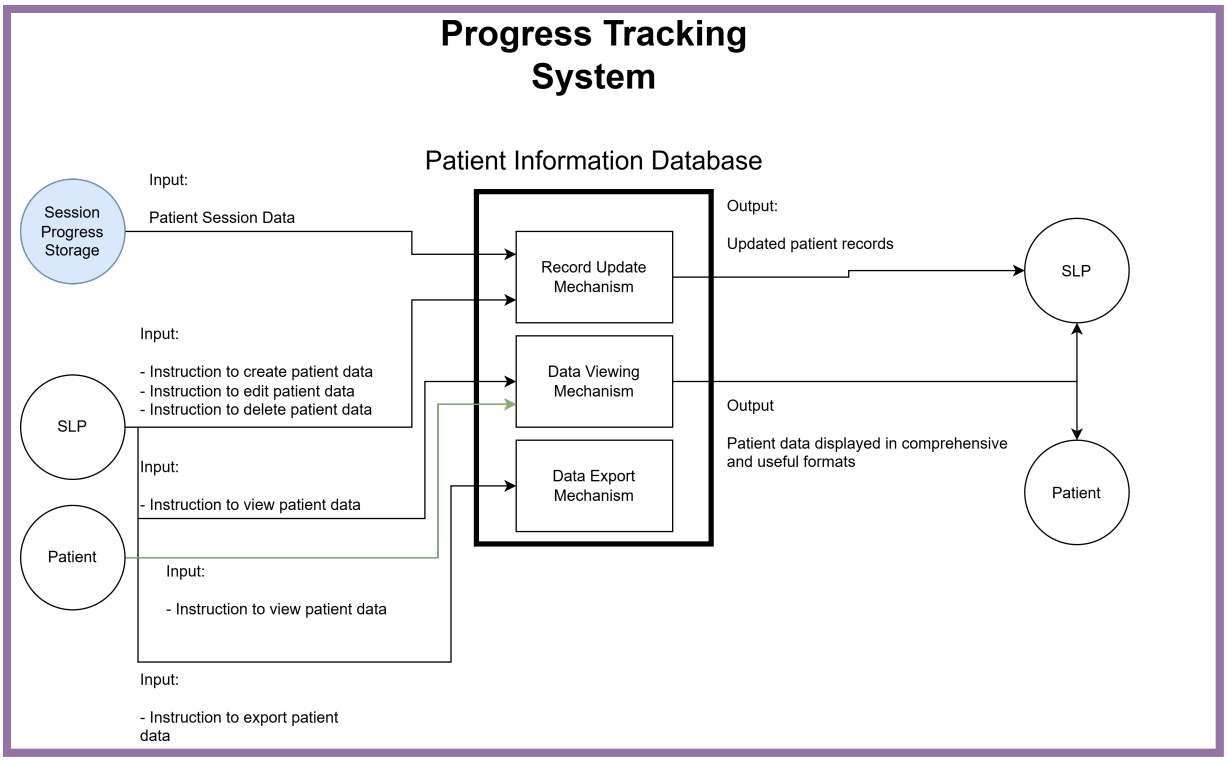


Figure 4: Progress Tracking System

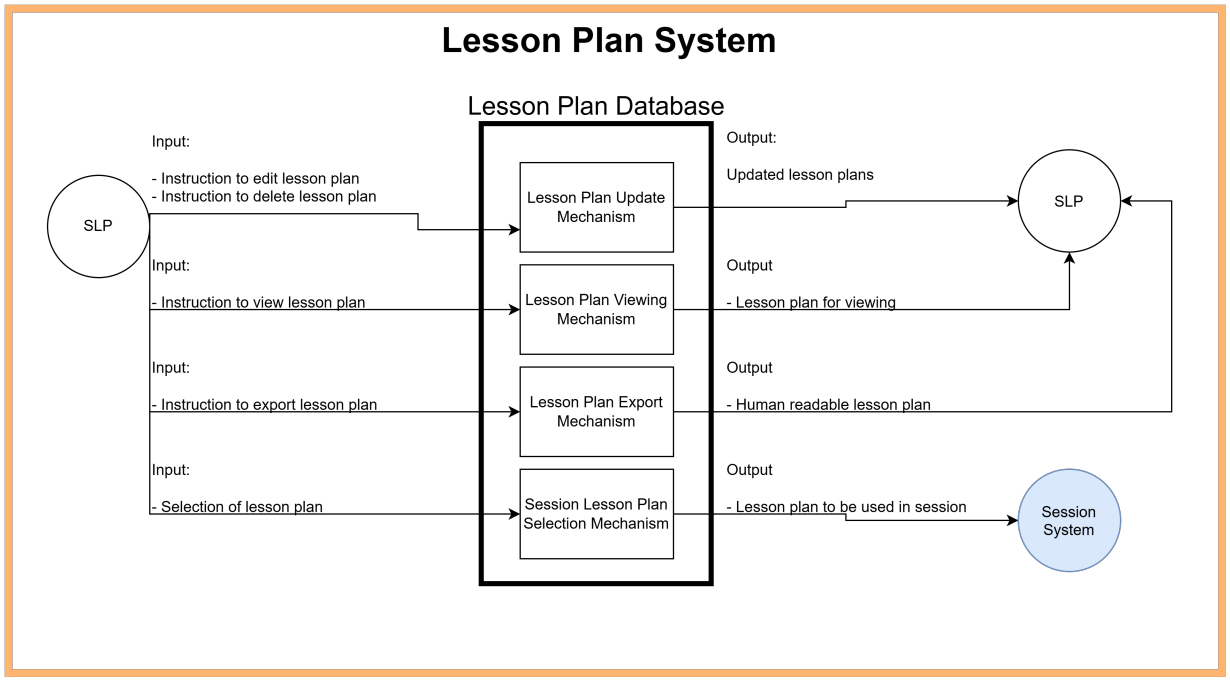


Figure 5: Lesson Plan System

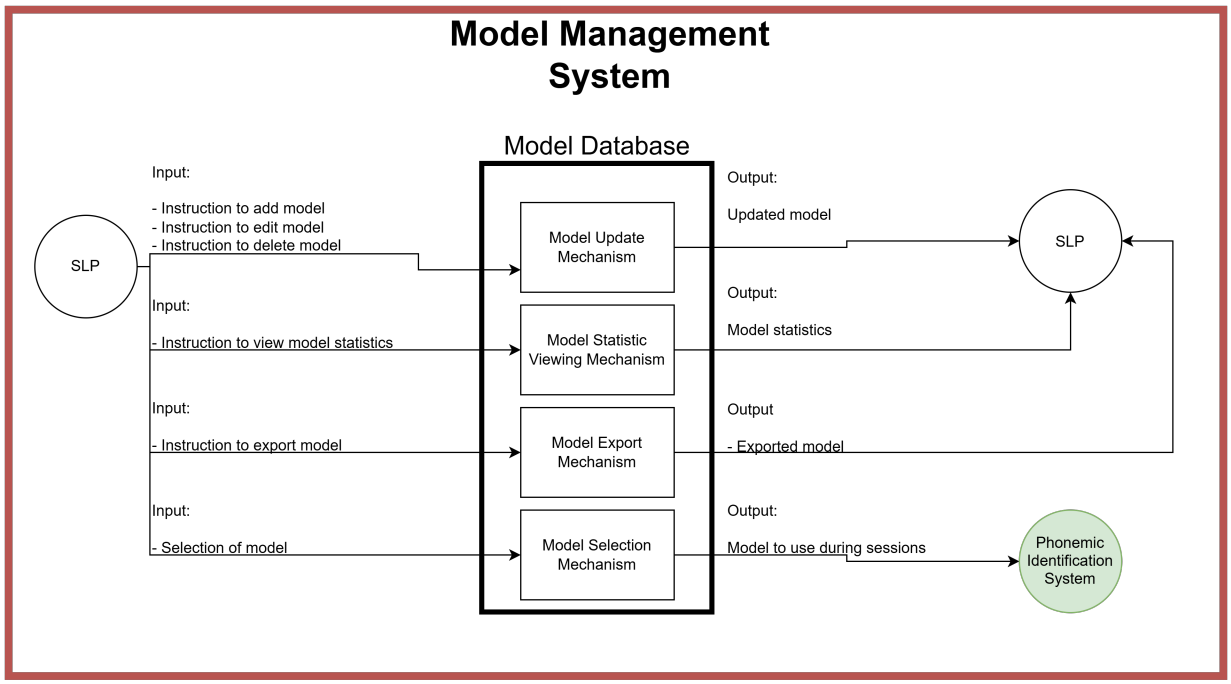


Figure 6: Model Management System

3.2 User Characteristics

3.2.1 Patient

- A patient is typically a child between the ages of 4-6 with an SSD like difficulties with substitutions
- A patient should be starting to learn how to read. PronouncedFish may use components that require a patient to read a sentence aloud. If a patient cannot read, alternative methods of treatment will be available in the system
- A patient should know how repeat a sentence said by an SLP when prompted. During treatment, an SLP may ask a patient to say a sentence to get an audio sample for phonemic analysis, the patient should be able to provide such a sentence when prompted
- A patient will likley still be learning how to pronounce fricative phonemes (/f/, /r/, /z/) but should have an understanding of plosive phonemes (/p/, /b/, /k/, /d/) and voiced phonemes (/w/, /m/, /n/). There are still some phonemes a child has not fully learned how to say yet which will be accounted for in the system
- Patients have limited digital literacy, they should not need to understand the internals of how the system works to use it
- A patient may not be able to understand advanced data or tracking information. The data provided by PronouncedFish should readable diagrams and data tracking statistics for children above the age of 4

3.2.2 SLP

- Expert in speech language pathology, they have a good understanding of phonemic analysis and are able to detect SSDs like substitutions.
- SLPs run sessions for patients, they decide which lessons to provide and which tools to use during a session to diagnose and treat SSDs. They have a good understanding of theses lessons and tools and know how to employ them effectively.
- SLPs are able to track and analyze a patient's data. They are able to use data to inform them of the SSDs a patient may have an how best to treat it. They can also use the data to track the progress of treatment for a patient and use that information to guide them on which tools are best to use for future sessions.
- SLPs are likely not experts in machine learning, they should not need an understanding of how machine learning works to use PronouncedFish.
- SLPs can use their judgements to formulate new lesson plans that are well tuned to a patients specicfic needs.

3.3 System Constraints

SC1: PronouncedFish and all of its functionalities must be able to run on an iPad or other kinds of tablets.
Rationale: Tablets are the most common tool for SLPs to use in a session. PronouncedFish must be able to run on existing SLP hardware to minimize the cost and training required for SLPs to be able to use the app.

SC2: PronouncedFish cannot function in noisy environments.
Rationale: The system will have a more difficult time isolating a patient's voice in an environment that is noisy. At a certain level of noise, the patient's voice is indistinguishable from the surrounding noise and the app will not be able to identify phonemes.

SC3: The system will need access the internet for authenticating a user account.
Rationale: SLPs will have accounts that they can use to access patient data, authentication of these accounts will need to happen through external services over the internet as it is infeasible to create a locally hosted authentication system.

4 Specific System Description

4.1 Problem Description

PronouncedFish is intended to solve the problem of identifying speech sound errors in young children during speech therapy sessions. Around 440,000 Canadians live with a speech, language, or communication disorder Communication Disabilities Access Canada (2026), including 7-10% of preschool children Gaines and Missiuna (2006). There are several types of speech sound errors that sessions with an SLP can help with. Identifying errors, and tracking whether they improve over time, is a core part of an SLP's work with a patient.

Current speech analysis tools that support SLPs are limited. According to the project supervisors, some tools do not perform well with both speed and accuracy, especially on children's voices. Additionally, current tools and models are not tailored to provide real-time and interpretable analysis to an SLP during a speech therapy session.

4.1.1 Physical System Description

PronouncedFish is a software system, but it is used within a physical setting. The physical setting for the software is a pediatric speech therapy session run by an SLP. The elements of the system's setting are described below.

PS1: The SLP

- Runs and supervises the therapy session.

PS2: The patient (children aged 4-6)

- Attends the therapy session, receiving cues and direction from the SLP, using the aid provided by PronouncedFish.

PS3: Clinic computer and technology

- Runs the PronouncedFish software, takes input from the SLP and patient.

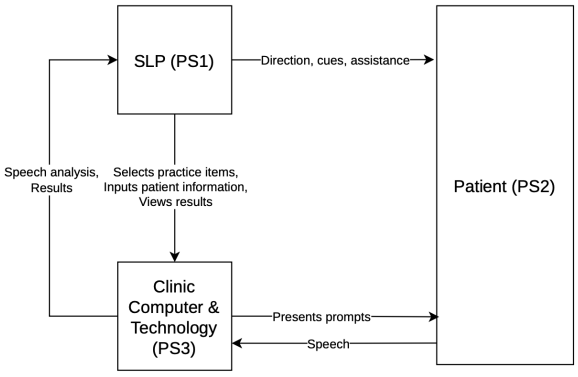


Figure 7: Physical System Description

4.1.2 Goal Statements

A detailed list of Problem Statement and Goals may be found here. For PronoucedFish, the goal statements are:

- **GS1**: Identify the substitution errors in a child's production of a practice item.
- **GS2**: Present the SLP with the results, including how the produced sounds differ from the expected sounds.
- **GS3**: Track a patient's performance on target sounds across sessions.
- **GS4**: Support the SLP in conducting practice with the child (prompts, item selection).

4.1.3 Scope Decisions

The following decisions are made to narrow down the scope of the project:

- **SD1**: The target demographic will be children aged 4-6.
  Rationale: A child's phonemic inventory (the sounds they are able to speak) typically stabilizes by ages 4-6 Kid Sense Child Development. If a child has speech development

issues at this point, they are referred to an SLP, making this a logical age range to choose. There is a lot more variation in speech at younger ages which may be normal, so younger age ranges are unrealistic to analyze for a capstone.

- **SD2**: The children will be monolingual speakers with a North-American accent.
  Rationale: Speech recognition tools struggle with recognizing mistakes in bilingual people or with accented speech Lee and Glasser (2026). These speakers incorrectly get flagged as having speech disorders more often due to a lack of training data available for them Lee and Glasser (2026). This means a general all-encompassing speech analysis model is unrealistic, and the project must focus on a space with sufficient training data to work from.

- **SD3**: The detected speech errors will be limited to consonant substitution errors.
  Rationale: There are four main types of speech errors as per the SODA framework, and addressing them all is a significant task. For this capstone, the main issues targeted are consonant substitution errors as they are the most common Crossroads Speech and Occupational Therapy and are unaffected by dialects, accents, and ways of speaking. This makes them feasible to target.

- **SD4**: Supported devices will be limited to iPadOS, AndroidOS, Windows desktops, and Macs.
  Rationale: When eliciting requirements with SLPs, the majority of them stated to use iPads to supplement their sessions. It is unrealistic to develop a native application for each and every operating system within the capstone timeline, so the most common platforms will be picked.

4.1.4 Assumptions

- **A1: Single-word attempts.** Each attempt consists of a single spoken target word.

- **A2: Speaker population.** Each speaker is a monolingual North American English-speaking child aged 4–6.

- **A3: Expected phoneme sequence.** Each target word is drawn from a standardized word set and has a predefined expected phoneme sequence $T = (t_1, \ldots, t_n)$.

- **A4: Acceptable pronunciation variants.** Each target word has a finite, predefined set of acceptable phoneme variants V_i at each position i, where $t_i \in V_i$.

  - These sets are established in consultation with an SLP advisor to account for acceptable pronunciation variation.

- **A5: Substitution errors.** Each substitution error involves replacing exactly one expected phoneme with a different phoneme at the same position.

- **A6: Sequence length mismatch.** Any difference between the recognized phoneme sequence length and the expected length n is assumed to indicate at least one omission or addition.
- **A7: SLP supervision.** Each session is conducted under the direct supervision of an SLP.
- **A8: Unintentional pronunciation errors.** All pronunciation errors made by the speaker are assumed to be unintentional.
- **A9: Recording conditions.** Each recording contains speech from only one speaker and is captured in a quiet environment with minimal background noise.
- **A10: Calibrated phoneme confidence.** The recognizer's per-phoneme posterior probabilities are assumed to be calibrated, such that predicted confidence values correspond to observed frequencies of correct recognition.
- **A11: Session devices.** SLPs are assumed to conduct sessions using an iPad, Android tablet, or computer equipped with a microphone and a modern web browser.

4.1.5 Theoretical Models

- **TM1: Phoneme recognition.** $R(x) = (P, \mathbf{c})$, where x is the recorded audio, $P = (p_1, \ldots, p_m)$ is the recognized phoneme sequence, and $\mathbf{c} = (c_1, \ldots, c_m)$ are per-phoneme posteriors with $c_j \in [0, 1]$.
  - Abstract mapping from audio to phonemes with confidence.
- **TM2: Phoneme sequence comparison.** Given T (expected) and P (recognized) with $|P| = n$, pair t_i with p_i for $i = 1, \ldots, n$.
  - Positional comparison is sufficient for substitutions, which are the only errors in scope.

4.1.6 General Definitions

- **GD1: Substitution at position i.** $s_i = 1$ if $p_i \notin V_i$ and $(t_i \to p_i) \in L$, otherwise $s_i = 0$, where L is the predetermined list of substitution errors.

4.1.7 Data Definitions

- **DD1: Word position.** $\text{pos}(i)$ is *beginning* if $i = 1$; *end* if $i = n$; otherwise *middle*.
  - Used to report where in the word each substitution occurs.

5 Requirements

This section provides the functional requirements, the business tasks that the software is expected to complete, and the nonfunctional requirements, the qualities that the software is expected to exhibit.

5.1 Functional Requirements

5.1.1 Audio Capture Requirements

- **FR-AC1:** The system shall capture the patient's spoken response as audio for each attempt.
  Rationale: Every analysis result is derived from the recording of an attempt.
- **FR-AC2:** The system shall use captured audio only to analyze the attempt it was captured for.
  Rationale: The system is scoped to data analysis only. Limiting the use of children's audio reduces privacy exposure under PHIPA.
- **FR-AC3:** The system shall flag to the SLP any recording that fails the usability limits (noise, clipping, duration).
  Rationale: Noisy or malformed audio is a main cause of misclassification, so the SLP must know when a result may be unreliable.

5.1.2 Session Management Requirements

- **FR-SM1:** The system shall allow the SLP to set up a session by selecting a patient, one or more target phonemes, and target items.
  Rationale: Target phonemes and items define what is practised and what the analysis compares against. Selectable phonemes are limited to those covered by the predetermined substitution list (FR-SA1).
- **FR-SM2:** The system shall allow the SLP to start, repeat, skip and end each attempt, and to end the session.
  Rationale: The SLP supervises the session and controls its pace.
- **FR-SM3:** The system shall allow the SLP to record, for each attempt, whether the target was produced independently, after a semantic cue, or after repetition.
  Rationale: The amount of support a patient needs is a clinical indicator of progress and is tracked across sessions.
- **FR-SM4:** The system shall allow the SLP to override the system's classification of any attempt.
  Rationale: The system's output is assistive and not diagnostic, so the SLP's clinical judgement takes precedence.

5.1.3 Speech Analysis Requirements

- **FR-SA1:** The system shall identify, from the captured audio of each attempt, substitutions from a predetermined list of common substitution errors, reporting the expected phoneme, the produced phoneme, and the word position.
  Rationale: Substitutions are the only error type in scope for the proof of concept, and accuracy is only validated for the listed errors. Word position supports the position-based visualization.

- **FR-SA2:** The system shall not identify a substitution when the produced phoneme matches any acceptable variant defined for the target item.
  Rationale: Accepted North American English pronunciation varies by dialect, and treating those variants as errors would produce false substitutions.

- **FR-SA3:** The system shall report a confidence value with each result and shall classify an attempt as "unclassifiable" when confidence is below the confidence threshold determined by the validation study.
  Rationale: The SLP can weigh uncertain results, and the system avoids forcing a classification on poor input, which reduces over-reliance on the tool.

5.1.4 Results & Data Visualization Requirements

- **FR-RDV1:** For each speech practise attempt (word or phrase), the system shall present the expected phonemes and the phonemes it recognized to the SLP.
  Rationale: The system must present this data side by side so the SLP can compare and draw conclusions from them.

- **FR-RDV2:** All substitution errors identified shall be displayed and indicate which expected phoneme was replaced by which produced phoneme.
  Rationale: The SLP must be informed of any errors and where they occured.

- **FR-RDV3:** The system shall include a visualization indicating the word position (beginning, middle, end) for each identified substitution.
  Rationale: The visualization will make it easier for SLPs, patients, and random users to interpret the speech analysis.

- **FR-RDV4:** The system shall include a visualization of the current session that reports, for the practice items (words/phrases) attempted, the number of correct and incorrect attempts, and, for the correct attempts, how many were produced independently and how many required additional cues or help from the SLP.
  Rationale: The visualization will make it easier for SLPs, patients, and random users to interpret a summary of correct, incorrect, independent, and cued attempts this session.

- **FR-RDV5:** The system shall include a heat-map visualization, indicating how close a produced phoneme is to the expected phoneme.

Rationale: Heat map shows produced phoneme closeness to expected phoneme for easy interpretation.

- **FR-RDV6:** The visualizations shall update as the session is completed.
  Rationale: Visualizations update automatically, so they can be reviewed as soon as the session is completed.

- **FR-RDV7:** The system shall identify and present all visualizations as assistive and not diagnostic.
  Rationale: All deductions are assistive, not diagnostic. It is important to remind users so they do not try using this to replace judgments of SLPs.

- **FR-RDV8:** The system shall not present error information in a way that discourages the patient.
  Rationale: Avoids discouraging error displays to support patient confidence.

- **FR-RDV9:** The system shall present phonemes as the appropriate IPA symbols.
  Rationale: IPA is the standard language used worldwide so these symbols must be used.

5.1.5 Progress & Data Management Requirements

- **FR-DMR1:** The system shall maintain, for each patient, a record of identifying information and session history.

- **FR-DMR2:** The system shall record the support level with the attempt it applies to.

  - **FR-DMR2.1:** The system shall allow the SLP to input, for each attempt, the level of support the child received (eg. no additional cues, semantic cue, repetition or model from the SLP).

  Rationale: Helps the SLP track patient progress directly within the app.

- **FR-DMR3:** The system shall allow the SLP to correct system output if they disagree with the system's analysis/recognition.

  - **FR-DMR3.1:** The system shall allow the SLP to mark an attempt as correct or incorrect regardless of the system's recognised output.

  Rationale: The SLP judgment always overrides that of the software. This tool is purely assistive and may not be right 100% of the time.

- **FR-DMR4:** For every instance in which a patient's record is viewed, created, modified, exported or deleted, the system shall record the type of information involved, the date and time, the identity of the user, and the identity of the patient the information pertains to.

Rationale: Audit log records information type, date, user, and patient to ensure traceability for all events.

- **FR-DMR5:** The system shall allow authorized users to retrieve the audit log and to provide a copy of it on request.
  Rationale: Authorized users can retrieve and copy the audit log for reference.

- **FR-DMR6:** The system shall record, for each session, the date, the SLP, the target phonemes and words, the session results, and inputs from the SLP.

- **FR-DMR7:** The system shall ensure that session results are associated only with the session patient.

- **FR-DMR8:** The system shall track each patient's performance on target phonemes over time. **Rationale:** Tracks each patient's target phoneme performance over time to make informed decisions about their progress and the effectiveness of therapy.

- **FR-DMR9:** The system shall allow the SLP to compare a patient's performance between sessions.
  Rationale: Allows the SLP to evaluate patient progress given their treatment.

- **FR-DMR10:** The system shall track and identify, for each patient, target phonemes that are showing improvement and those with persistent errors.
  Rationale: Identifies improving target phonemes and persistent error patterns.

- **FR-DMR11:** The system shall record whether a correct practised item (word/phrase) required additional cues or repetition to be achieved.

5.1.6 Practice Activities Requirements

- **FR-PAR1:** The system shall provide a set of practise items (words or phrases), each associated with the target phoneme(s) each one exercises and the position of that phoneme in the word.
  Rationale: Allows patients to participate in speech activities directly within the app.

- **FR-PAR2:** The system shall provide at least 3 practice items for each target phoneme in each word position (eg: with 15 target phonemes -¿ 15* 3 word positions * 3 items = 135 practice items).
  Rationale: Ensures there is sufficient practice material for patients to use.

- **FR-PAR3:** The system shall allow the SLP to select practice items by target phoneme and word position.
  Rationale: Allows all users to filter through and pick practice problems specific to their needs.

- **FR-PAR4:** The practise items shall be appropriate for the supported age range (4-6) and be drawn from a standardized set of words (i.e. Goldman Fristoe).
- **FR-PAR5:** For each practice item, the system shall present a prompt that elicits the child to produce the item without the SLP saying first.
  - **FR-PAR5.1:** Prompts shall be in the form of image cues, rather than written words.
  - **FR-PAR5.2:** Prompts shall be recognisable and appropriate.

  Rationale: Presents prompts that elicit child speech without SLP modeling.
- **FR-PAR6:** The system shall allow the SLP to move to the next item, repeat an item, skip an item, or end the practice at any time.
  Rationale: Gives the SLP complete control of the session based on how they judge patient progress and needs.
- **FR-PAR7:** The system shall include elements that keep patients engaged during practice.

5.2 Nonfunctional Requirements

5.2.1 Accuracy Requirements

- **NFR-ACCU1:** The accuracy of the system for identifying phonemes will be 87% which will be measured against the analysis and judgement of one or more speech language pathologists (SLPs).
  Rationale: Many models created after 2020 for phonemic analysis are able to achieve accuracies around the 80-90% range Sun and Cao (2026).

5.2.2 Performance Requirements

- **NFR-PER1:** Phonemic estimation results must be presented in less than 10 seconds for a short sentence.
  Rationale: This is because 10 seconds is the limit for sustaining a user's attention during a human-computer dialogue before they will want to perform other tasks Nielsen.

5.2.3 Usability Requirements

- **NFR-USA1:** The SLP must be able to fully navigate the software within one hour of use.
  Rationale: We expect that it will take some time to become accustomed to the software, but we do not want the software to be a time sink.

- **NFR-USA2:** The SLP cannot delete critical data without a confirmation or the ability to recover it within 72 hours.
  Rationale: This provides a safety net for the SLP to prevent accidental deletion of critical data.

- **NFR-USA3:** The time spent using the software tool during and outside of a session should be less than the time spent using equivalent manual tools.
  Rationale: The software is intended to improve efficiency, and any loss in efficiency would be counterproductive.

- **NFR-USA4:** The child cannot access the rest of the system beyond the gamified experience.
  Rationale: This provides a safety measure to ensure that the child cannot access data without the supervision of the SLP.

5.2.4 Maintainability Requirements

- **NFR-MAI1:** The software should be modular to allow extension to interfaces for other professions (e.g., accent coaches and language teachers).
  Rationale: We anticipate the value of extending the software, and a modular design facilitates this.

- **NFR-MAI2:** The software should be modular to allow extension to other speech differences under SODA.
  Rationale: We anticipate the value of extending the software, and a modular design facilitates this.

- **NFR-MAI3:** Building and deploying a patch should take less than 30 minutes.
  Rationale: This is to ensure that the software is updated in a timely manner, ideally before the next session with a child for critical bug fixes.

5.2.5 Portability Requirements

- **NFR-POR1:** The web-based application should work on Windows, macOS, iOS, and Android.
  Rationale: Although this is a web-based application, compatibility with common operating systems still needs to be ensured.

- **NFR-POR2:** The web-based application should work on Chrome, Firefox, Safari, and Edge browsers.
  Rationale: This covers some of the most commonly used browsers, including default browsers such as Safari on macOS and Edge on Windows.

- **NFR-POR3:** The web-based application should work on desktop, tablet, and laptop devices.

Rationale: The majority of SLPs will likely use one of these devices, with iPads (tablets) being particularly common L. Turkstra.

5.2.6 Reliability Requirements

- **NFR-REL1:** Server-side actions (login/out, data storage and retrieval) have a maximum latency of 10 seconds.
  Rationale: Should SLPs be using the program frequently, SLPs can almost always be sure any transaction they make with servers will take at most 10 seconds.

- **NFR-REL2:** The system will operate at max performance from 6am to 12am.
  Rationale: Since there will be portions of PronouncedFish that are continuously operational (data storage and authentication), those systems will operate at max efficiency during the times that SLPs are most likely to conduct treatments, those times being 6am-12am.

- **NFR-REL3:** The system will be minimally operational between 12am to 6am outside of SLP work hours.
  Rationale: Since there will be portions of PronouncedFish that are continuously operational (data storage and authentication), there will be times where the system is not being extensively used (mainly outside of SLP work hours). During those times, the system can operate slower and consume less energy to run since the number of people using the system at that time is few to zero.

- **NFR-REL4:** Required maintenance, system health checkups, and system updates happen no more than every 1-2 months and during minimal operation hours
  Rationale: Possible server or data storage maintenance will be required to keep the system running and trusted. Whenever non-critical checkups/maintenance/updates need to happen, they will happen during SLP off hours so the impact on the SLPs are minimized.

5.2.7 Security and Privacy:

- **NFR-SAP1:** The system will encrypt all PHI as it is collected using strong up-to-date encryption standards
  Rationale: To protect user information from cyber attacks, any sensitive health information that may be collected or used in treatments is immediately encrypted. This prevents attackers from reading or getting significant information on a patient.

- **NFR-SAP2:** The system will use a secure cryptographic protocol for communications for all data traffic between system components
  Rationale: The system may require PHI to be sent through the internet, especially for data management. This leaves it open to interception by third parties, therefore, a secure communication protocol that prevents third parties from interpreting sensitie information.

- **NFR-SAP3:** The system will provide outlets for SLPs to anonymize PHI that is collected from a patient.
  Rationale: Data must be able to be anonymised to remain compliant with PHIPA and prevent compromised data from being used to identify patients.

5.2.8 Legal and Licensing:

- **NFR-LAL1:** The system will follow the Personal Health Information Protection Act (PHIPA) guidelines for data storage, data transfer, data access and data residency.
  Rationale: SLPs are required to work within the guidelines of PHIPA to protect patient information. Thus, the tools they use in sessions must also not violate PHIPA guidelines.

- **NFR-LAL2:** The system will be open source using the GNU General Public License (GPL).
  Rationale: The materials that are used to make PronouncedFish are licensed under the GNU GPL. Thus, PronouncedFish itself becomes licensed under GNU GPL and becomes open source.

6 Likely Changes

Below is a list of requirements that are likely to change. The provided rationale will explain whether this is due to a scope decision, stretch goal, or other factor.

- **LC1**: The speech analysis model shall identify omission, distortion and addition phonetic articulation errors as described in the SODA framework.
  Rationale: Due to scope requirements, speech error detection has been limited to just substitution errors for this project. Ideally, this will be changed to analyze all forms of errors.
  Related Assumption(s): A5, A6

- **LC2**: The speech analysis model will fairly accommodate accents originating from regions outside North America. Fair implies the model will recognize errors at a comparable accuracy (+/- 5% relative to the North American accent) for speakers of any accent.
  Rationale: Due to scope requirements, the child's accent has been limited to just Monolingual North American speakers. English speakers are very diverse, and there must be adequate support for users from all backgrounds.
  Related Assumption(s): A2

- **LC3**: The system shall provide an interface for an SLP to assign homework to their patients.
  Rationale: The first iteration of the system will provide an interface for an SLP-led session in the clinic. A stretch goal is to allow patients to complete homework at home,

but this is not a core feature, so it is a likely change.
Related Assumption(s): A7

- **LC4**: The system shall highlight errors for children of all age ranges based on the standardized speech sound development chart.
Rationale: Due to scope requirements, the target child age has been restricted to ages 4-6. Speech errors may occur at any age, and even for adults. Therefore, more flexibility will be crucial in future iterations of the product.
Related Assumption(s): A2

- **LC5**: The system will support being locally hosted on Windows and Mac operating systems. The system will have compatible mobile apps for iOS and Android OS. The system will be supported in Safari and Google Chrome browsers.
Rationale: SLPs may conduct their sessions using iPad, tablet, or computer microphones, so all platforms must be supported. They also deal with confidential patient health information, so web-based solutions may not be trusted.
Related Assumption(s): A11

7 Unlikely Changes

- **UC1:** The system will shift its focus to working with adults instead of children.
Rationale: The goal of PronouncedFish is to help children with SSDs in the early stages of their phoneme-pronouncing journey. Switching to working with adults will require different models for phonemic identification and different datasets to train them to be effective.

- **UC2:** The system will change its guidelines from PHIPA to something else.
Rationale: Since Ontarian SLPs mostly work with PHIPA, using a different guideline would be counterproductive and unrepresentative of the target SLP user base. The guidelines should only change if new laws are enacted that supersede PHIPA.

- **UC3:** The system will shift its focus away from English speakers.
Rationale: Whilst in theory possible for PronouncedFish to work with languages other than English, members of the team and the supervisors primarily work with English speaking patients, thus the models and system should be fine-tuned to work with English speakers.

- **UC4:** The system will use generative AI to create lesson plans.
Rationale: SLPs are the experts when it comes to knowing what a patient needs to treat their SSDs. While this feature is possible to implement, Ghoti entrusts the responsibility of creating new lesson plans with the SLPs due to their expertise.

8 Traceability Matrices and Graphs

The following traceability matrices map relationships between the various requirements and design decisions made throughout this document. The first one traces relations between the functional and non-functional system requirements. The second matrix links the assumptions to all other goals, scope decisions, and items. Each relation is marked by an X between the corresponding items.

Table 3: Traceability Matrix: Functional and Nonfunctional Requirements (1)

Functional	**Nonfunctional**								
	ACU1	**PER1**	**USA1**	**USA2**	**USA3**	**USA4**	**MAI1**	**MAI2**	**MAI3**
AC1	X	X	X						
AC2									
AC3	X	X							X
SM1			X						
SM2			X						
SM3			X						
SM4			X						
SA1	X	X			X			X	X
SA2	X	X			X			X	X
SA3	X	X			X			X	X
RDV1			X		X			X	
RDV2			X		X				
RDV3			X		X				
RDV4			X		X				
RDV5			X		X			X	
RDV6					X				
RDV7			X						
RDV8									
RDV9			X						
DMR1									
DMR2			X		X				
DMR3			X						
DMR4			X	X		X	X		
DMR5			X			X			
DMR6									
DMR7									
DMR8									
DMR9			X						
DMR10									
DMR11									
PAR1			X						
PAR2									
PAR3									
PAR4									
PAR5									
PAR6			X						
PAR7									

Table 4: Traceability Matrix: Functional and Nonfunctional Requirements (2)

Functional	**Nonfunctional**											
	POR1	**POR2**	**POR3**	**REL1**	**REL2**	**REL3**	**REL4**	**SAP1**	**SAP2**	**SAP3**	**LAL1**	**LAL2**
AC1	X	X	X	X					X			X
AC2				X				X	X			X
AC3				X				X				X
SM1								X	X			X
SM2												X
SM3									X			X
SM4												X
SA1				X					X			X
SA2				X								X
SA3				X	X	X						X
RDV1												X
RDV2												X
RDV3				X								X
RDV4				X								X
RDV5				X								X
RDV6				X	X	X						X
RDV7												X
RDV8												X
RDV9												X
DMR1	X				X	X	X	X	X		X	X
DMR2											X	X
DMR3								X			X	X
DMR4					X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
DMR5	X	X	X					X		X	X	X
DMR6				X				X			X	X
DMR7								X	X		X	X
DMR8											X	X
DMR9				X							X	X
DMR10				X					X		X	X
DMR11											X	X
PAR1												X
PAR2												X
PAR3												X
PAR4											X	X
PAR5									X			X
PAR6												X
PAR7												X

Table 5: Traceability Matrix: Assumptions and Other SRS Components

Items	**A1**	**A2**	**A3**	**A4**	**A5**	**A6**	**A7**	**A8**	**A9**	**A10**	**A11**
GS1	X		X	X	X						
GS2			X	X	X	X	X	X		X	
GS3	X		X					X		X	
GS4							X				
SD1		X						X			
SD2		X		X							
SD3	X		X	X	X					X	
SD4									X		X
TM1			X	X				X		X	
TM2			X			X		X		X	
GD1			X		X						
DD1			X								
LC1					X	X					
LC2		X		X							
LC3							X				
LC4		X									
LC5									X		X
UC1		X									
UC2							X				
UC3		X	X	X							
UC4							X				

9 Development Plan

Proof of Concept: For the proof of concept we will focus on implementing the phonemic analysis for substitution erros and some APIs to expose the data statistics to the rest of the system. We intend to do accuracy and performance testing in this phase to ensure the phonemic analysis meets those non-functional requirements. **Phase 1:** This is the phase that will be presented at the Capstone Expo. The interfaces should be complete for an SLP with a login, data visualization, lesson planning tools, progress tracking for the patients, and a game for the patients. The backend should have a modular design, and a database. The database will be real but will not be clinically ready as it will be a free Cloud service. Some basic security measures, such as two-factor authentication, will be put in place to protect patient data. The system should work in every selected browser, operating system, and device. **Phase 2:** Additional phonemic analysis will be implemented for other types of errors in SODA. The interface will be expanded to support data analysis and progress tracking for these errors as well as specialized games. **Phase 3:** Security, privacy, and PHIPPA/medical requirements will be met in this phase. This is through proper agreements with Cloud services or the implementation of locally hosted services. Additional security measures will be implemented to ensure cybersecurity and the protection of malicious actors accessing sensitive data. This is the phase that ensures that the software is fully ready for clinical deployment and use. **Phase 4 and on:** This is the phase where the software will be further into a line of software products for various professions and applications. Additional phonemic analysis may be required for this to detect speech differences that do not fall under SODA such as prosody.

References

Communication Disabilities Access Canada. People who have communication disabilities, 2026. URL https://www.cdacanada.com/resources/communication-disabilities/statistics/.

Crossroads Speech and Occupational Therapy. Articulation & phonology. URL https://crossroadsspeechtherapy.com/articulation_phonology/. Date is the page's last-modified time.

Robin Gaines and Cheryl Missiuna. Early identification: Are toddlers with speech/language impairments at increased risk for developmental coordination disorder? CanChild Centre for Childhood-Onset Disability Research, McMaster University, 2006. URL https://canchild.ca/resources/96-early-identification-are-toddlers-with-speech-language-impairments-at-increased-risk-for-developmer

Government of Ontario. Preschool speech and language program. URL https://www.ontario.ca/page/preschool-speech-and-language-program. Last updated January 20, 2026.

Kid Sense Child Development. Speech sounds development chart. URL https://childdevelopment.com.au/resources/child-development-charts/speech-sounds-developmental-chart/. Chart is a functional screening tool, not a standardised assessment; date is the page's last-modified time.

D. Pape L. Turkstra. Initial meeting with supervisors. In-person conversation.

S. A. S. Lee and C. Glasser. Language-common and language-specific error patterns in children with speech sound disorders: A systematic review. *Journal of Speech, Language, and Hearing Research*, 69(7):3085–3115, July 2026. doi: 10.1044/2026_JSLHR-25-00850.

Jakob Nielsen. Response times: The 3 important limits. URL https://www.nngroup.com/articles/response-times-3-important-limits/. Excerpt from Chapter 5 of *Usability Engineering* (1993); web-application update added 2014.

W. Spencer Smith and Nirmitha Koothoor. A document-driven method for certifying scientific computing software for use in nuclear safety analysis. *Nuclear Engineering and Technology*, 48(2):404–418, April 2016. ISSN 1738-5733. doi: http://dx.doi.org/10.1016/j.net.2015.11.008. URL http://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S1738573315002582.

W. Spencer Smith and Lei Lai. A new requirements template for scientific computing. In J. Ralyté, P. Ågerfalk, and N. Kraiem, editors, *Proceedings of the First International Workshop on Situational Requirements Engineering Processes – Methods, Techniques and Tools to Support Situation-Specific Requirements Engineering Processes, SREP'05*, pages 107–121, Paris, France, 2005. In conjunction with 13th IEEE International Requirements Engineering Conference.

W. Spencer Smith, Lei Lai, and Ridha Khedri. Requirements analysis for engineering computation: A systematic approach for improving software reliability. *Reliable Computing, Special Issue on Reliable Engineering Computation*, 13(1):83–107, February 2007.

Chuanhui Sun and Qiuwen Cao. Automatic english pronunciation assessment method based on deep learning. *7th International Conference on Cyber Security Intelligence and Analytics*, 2026. URL https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S1877050926024889.

Appendix — Reflection

The information in this section will be used to evaluate the team members on the graduate attribute of Lifelong Learning.

The purpose of reflection questions is to give you a chance to assess your own learning and that of your group as a whole, and to find ways to improve in the future. Reflection is an important part of the learning process. Reflection is also an essential component of a successful software development process.

Reflections are most interesting and useful when they're honest, even if the stories they tell are imperfect. You will be marked based on your depth of thought and analysis, and not based on the content of the reflections themselves. Thus, for full marks we encourage you to answer openly and honestly and to avoid simply writing "what you think the evaluator wants to hear."

Please answer the following questions. Some questions can be answered on the team level, but where appropriate, each team member should write their own response:

1. What went well while writing this deliverable?
   Before beginning the deliverable, the group discussed each of the required sections together and took detailed notes for each one. This helped with writing the deliverable because everyone in the group was on the same page and understood the approach we wanted to take. This allowed us to easily divide up the writing work and ensure that each section would be cohesive and unified. Additionally, the group set an internal deadline to complete the writing the day before the official deliverable due date. This helped keep us on track and accountable for our work. Additionally, we were able to make some improvmenets on the group's workflow from deliverable 1 and address some pain points experienced for that one.

2. What pain points did you experience during this deliverable, and how did you resolve them?
   Like with the last deliverable, our group had to deal with some technical difficulties. For example, several team members ran into difficulties with GitHub and merge conflicts. We were able to resolve these by working together and using pull requests. We also had some challenges with finding and chooseing the appropriate templates for each deliverable, as guidance on this was spread across several locations and requirements weren't always clear. We resolved this by sticking to the SRS checklist and askign for clarification where we were unsure.

3. How many of your requirements were inspired by speaking to your client(s) or their proxies (e.g. your peers, stakeholders, potential users)?
   Many of the requirements were inspired by conversations with our supervisors. Their input was really valuable in refining our scope and identifying what would actually be useful to an SLP during a session.

4. Which of the courses you have taken, or are currently taking, will help your team to be successful with your capstone project.
   Our Human Computer Interfaces course will help us design an interface that supports the SLP's workflow and that is usable for young children. Our Requirements Engineering course has helped us write clear requirements and will continue to help us trace them through the project. Our Software Architecture course will help us with the structure of the system and design decisions.

5. What knowledge and skills will the team collectively need to acquire to successfully complete this capstone project? Examples of possible knowledge to acquire include domain specific knowledge from the domain of your application, or software engineering knowledge, mechatronics knowledge or computer science knowledge. Skills may be related to technology, or writing, or presentation, or team management, etc. You should look to identify at least one item for each team member.
   The team will need to acquire the following knowledge and skills:
   Phonetics and child speech challenges, speech analysis models, evaluaiton of speech analysis accuracy, healthcare privacy and secure data handling, and audio capture. The team will split these 5 skills areas amongst each other.

6. For each of the knowledge areas and skills identified in the previous question, what are at least two approaches to acquiring the knowledge or mastering the skill? Of the identified approaches, which will each team member pursue, and why did they make this choice?
   For phonetics and child speech challenges, we will ask our supervisors for details on the international pheonetic alphabet and research introductory phoentics information. For speech analysis models, we will work with existing models and documentation to build our knowledge and research other projects that have been done on speech analysis. For evaluation of speech analysis accuracy, we will study existing benchmarks for the models and run our own tests using them. For healthcare privacy, we will read documentation on PHIPA regulations and consult our supervisors. For audio capture, we will test mockups and consult with our supervisors.